

SKILLFORGE AI

The Social Media AI Playbook — SkillForge AI

How a one-person business runs Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, and Pinterest with AI doing the heavy lifting

WHAT IT IS

The complete operating system for running Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, and Pinterest as a one-person business — with an AI assistant doing the heavy lifting.

WHO IT'S FOR

Local service businesses, trades, shops, and Main Street owners who do their own marketing.

WHAT YOU NEED

Any general AI chat assistant and about 20 minutes a day. No software to buy, no jargon required.

WHAT YOU'LL BUILD

A discovery interview, a one-page full-picture synthesis, and an approved 90-day plan — then the execution system: content pillars, a one-idea-five-posts repurposing engine, platform playbooks, hook frameworks, a daily engagement routine, and a weekly review loop.

Written by Muse for Bill Morton
SkillForge AI — practical AI playbooks for Main Street

What's inside

A note from Bill

How to use this playbook

Chapter 1: The discovery interview — start with questions, not posts

Chapter 2: The full picture — one page that says everything

Chapter 3: Present the plan — and get the yes

Quick-Start: your first week after approval

Chapter 4: Pick your content pillars

Chapter 5: The repurposing engine — one idea, five posts

Chapter 6: Facebook — your home base

Chapter 7: Instagram

Chapter 8: YouTube

Chapter 9: Pinterest

Chapter 10: Hooks and copy frameworks

Chapter 11: The engagement routine

Chapter 12: Read the numbers, then iterate

Chapter 13: Build the community

Chapter 14: Guardrails

Your 90-day calendar: putting it all together

Every chapter ends with exact, copy-paste prompts. Fill in the brackets, make the words sound like you, and put the rhythm on your calendar.

A note from Bill

I'm Bill Morton. I run small businesses, and I do my own marketing — all of it, across Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, and Pinterest, for more than one brand at a time. I don't have a marketing department. I don't have an agency on retainer. I have a process, and I have an AI assistant doing the heavy lifting inside that process.

This playbook is that process, written down. Not theory. The actual weekly rhythm: what gets posted, where, when, how we talk to people, and how we read the numbers and change what's not working.

A few things to know before you start:

Everything in here works with any general AI chat assistant — the kind you type into and it writes back. I don't name specific tools on purpose. The tools change every few months; the workflows don't. If your assistant can write, rewrite, and summarize, you're set.

AI drafts. You decide. Nothing in this playbook goes out under your name without your eyes on it first. AI gives you the clay; you shape it. Your customers can smell a form letter, and they'll forgive a rough edge a lot faster than they'll forgive something fake.

This is a marathon system, not a viral lottery ticket. Nothing here promises you'll "go viral." What it promises is a business that shows up every day, gets a little better every week, and compounds. That's how small businesses actually win on social media.

One more thing, and it shapes the whole book: **we don't start with posting. We start with an interview.** Before a single post is planned, you learn the business — their goals, their customers, their offers, their constraints. Then you turn what you learned into one clear picture, present a plan for approval, and only then start executing. Interview, picture, approval, execution — in that order, every time. The chapters are arranged exactly that way.

Let's get to work.

How to use this playbook

- 1. Interview (Chapter 1).** Learn the business first — goals, customers, offers, constraints, voice, resources, success metrics. One question at a time. No posting, no planning.
- 2. Synthesize (Chapter 2).** Turn the interview answers into a one-page full picture. Hunt for contradictions. Fix the vague parts.
- 3. Present for approval (Chapter 3).** Draft the 90-day plan, present it, and get an explicit yes. Record the approval — date, what was approved, what changed.
- 4. Execute (Chapters 4–14).** Only after approval. Start with the Quick-Start sprint — your first approved week — then use the rest of the book as your reference shelf.

Every chapter ends with exact prompts. Copy them, paste them into your AI assistant, fill in the brackets, and adjust the words until they sound like you. The prompts are the product as much as the chapters are.

Assign one person. This playbook fails if it's everybody's job. Even if that person is you — put it on the calendar like a staff meeting. Twenty focused minutes a day beats four distracted hours on Sunday.

The ground rules for the whole book:

- Never post anything you haven't read. (AI drafts, you decide.)
- Never invent a fact, a number, a review, or a customer. If you don't know it, don't post it.
- No politics. Ever. Your business page is not the place.
- If a platform warns you, throttles you, or blocks an action — stop for the day. Pushing through gets accounts restricted. Patience is a growth strategy.

Chapter 1: The discovery interview — start with questions, not posts

Nothing in this book works until you know the business. The pillars, the hooks, the daypart map — all of that is machinery, and machinery pointed at the wrong target just gets you to the wrong place faster.

So the playbook starts here: a discovery interview. One conversation — or one sitting with your AI assistant — that gets the full picture of the business before a single post is planned.

Who runs the interview? If you're doing marketing for a customer, you interview them. If you're the owner doing your own marketing, you still do it — interview yourself with the prompt below and write the answers down. Skipping it because "I already know my business" is how you end up with a plan built on assumptions instead of facts.

How to run it: ask one question at a time. Don't batch five questions into one breath — people answer the last one and forget the first four. Write every answer down. And don't skip an area because it seems obvious. "Obvious" is where the surprises hide.

There are nine areas. Cover all nine, in order:

- 1. The business.** What do you do, in one sentence? What do you actually sell? Who pays you? How long have you been at it? Is it just you, or is there a team? Where are you, and how far do your customers come from?
- 2. Goals.** What should social media do for this business — more bookings, more calls, more foot traffic, more email signups? What's the 90-day goal, in plain numbers? What about a year from now?
- 3. Offers.** What are the two or three things you actually sell? What does each cost, roughly? Which one is the flagship — the thing you're known for? Anything seasonal?
- 4. The preferred customer.** Who is the ideal buyer? Not "everyone" — the specific person. Age range, situation, the problem they're trying to solve, what they care about when they choose someone like you, where they already hang out online.

5. Channels. Where are you right now — Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, Pinterest, email? What have you tried, and what actually worked? What flopped? Do you have a website? An email list?

6. Constraints. How much time a day can this honestly get? Any budget — even zero is an answer. Who's doing the posting — you, an employee, nobody yet? Anything off-limits: topics you won't touch, photos you can't use, seasons when you're too busy to post?

7. Brand voice. If your business talked like a person, how would it sound? Give me three words. What's something you'd never say? Tell me about a post you loved writing — or one you hated.

8. Resources. What do you have to work with? A phone camera? A shop full of photogenic work? Old photos, old posts, a box of customer thank-you notes? Customers who'd say nice things on camera?

9. Success metrics. What does winning look like in 90 days? Name the number: bookings per month, calls per week, email signups, foot traffic. What result would make you say "this was worth it"?

When all nine areas are answered, stop. You have raw material — not a plan. Chapter 2 turns it into the full picture. Don't plan yet. Don't post yet.

The exact prompts

Run my discovery interview:

Interview me about my business so you can build my social media plan. Ask me ONE question at a time and wait for my answer before asking the next. Cover these nine areas, in order: (1) the business — what I do, what I sell, who pays me, how long, team size, location and service area; (2) my goals — what social media should do for the business, my 90-day goal in plain numbers, my one-year goal; (3) my offers — the 2–3 things I actually sell, rough prices, the flagship, anything seasonal; (4) my preferred customer — the specific ideal buyer, their situation, the problem they're solving, what they care about, where they hang out online; (5) my channels — where I am now, what's worked, what's flopped, website and email list; (6) my constraints — honest daily time, budget, who's posting, anything off-limits, busy seasons; (7) my brand voice — three words for how I sound, something I'd never say; (8) my resources — phone camera, photos, old content, customers who'd give testimonials; (9) my success metrics — what winning looks like in 90 days, the number that would make me say this was worth it. Do not plan anything yet. When I've answered all nine areas, stop and tell me we're ready for the synthesis.

Chapter 2: The full picture — one page that says everything

Interview answers are raw material. The synthesis turns them into one page that anyone can read and say "yes, that's the business." If the interview is the conversation, the full picture is the receipt.

Build it as nine boxes, mirroring the nine interview areas. Short, plain, no fluff:

BUSINESS SNAPSHOT — what they do, who pays them, where. Two or three sentences.

90-DAY GOAL / ONE-YEAR GOAL — the plain-numbers targets from the interview.

OFFERS — the two or three things they sell, rough prices, the flagship, seasonal notes.

IDEAL CUSTOMER — five lines: who they are, their situation, the problem they're solving, what they value when choosing, where they hang out online.

CHANNELS — where they are now, what's working, what's dead.

CONSTRAINTS — honest daily time, budget, who's posting, what's off-limits, busy seasons.

VOICE — three words, one thing they'd say, one thing they'd never say.

RESOURCES — what exists to build with: photos, old content, testimonials, the shop itself.

SUCCESS METRICS — the number that means "this was worth it."

Then read it back and hunt for contradictions. This is the step that earns its keep. A goal of thirty new bookings a month on ten minutes a day doesn't fit — one of them has to change, and it's better to find that out here than in week six. A flagship offer with no photos and a "visual-first" channel plan doesn't fit either.

If any box is vague — "customers are everyone," "we want more business" — go back and ask one more question. The picture is only as good as the answers in it.

When the full picture reads true — no contradictions, no vague boxes — you're ready for Chapter 3. Still not time to post.

The exact prompts

Synthesize my full picture:

Here are my discovery interview answers: [PASTE THEM]. Turn them into a one-page full-picture summary with these nine sections: Business Snapshot (2–3 sentences), 90-Day Goal and One-Year Goal, Offers, Ideal Customer (five lines: who, their situation, their problem, what they value, where they hang out online), Channels (current, working, dead), Constraints, Brand Voice (three words plus one thing I'd say and one I'd never say), Resources, and Success Metrics (the number that means this was worth it). Plain language, no fluff. Then flag any contradictions — for example a goal that doesn't fit the stated time or budget — and tell me which interview answer needs one more question.

Chapter 3: Present the plan — and get the yes

Here is the rule this whole book is built on: **nothing in Chapters 4 through 14 starts until the plan is approved.** Not skimmed, not "we'll figure it out as we go" — approved. An unapproved plan is a guess. Approval is what turns the plan into a commitment — from the customer, or from yourself.

What the approval-ready plan contains

Seven pieces, all drawn from the full picture in Chapter 2:

1. **The full picture** — the one-page summary. The plan opens with "here's what I heard" before it ever says "here's what I recommend."
2. **The channels** — which platforms you'll run and why, tied to where the ideal customer actually spends time. Not everywhere — where it counts.
3. **The content pillars** — the five pillars from Chapter 4, shaped for *this* business from the interview answers. Not generic pillars; theirs.
4. **The cadence** — how often you'll post, on which days, in which slots — built to fit the real time available, not the aspirational kind.
5. **The 90-day calendar** — sketched month by month: foundations, rhythm, scale-what-wins.
6. **What success looks like** — the metrics from the interview, the weekly review rhythm from Chapter 12, and the effectiveness rule: what you'll change, and when, if something stays flat.
7. **What you need from the customer** — logins, photos, how fast they'll review drafts, who approves what. A plan without this list is a plan with a hidden stall in it.

How to present it

Thirty minutes, in person or on a call. Walk the full picture first, then the plan, then the ask. Or send the written plan ahead and take fifteen minutes of questions. Either way, speak outcomes, not tactics — "three bookings a week from Facebook" lands; "we'll post at 6:15 AM" doesn't.

What counts as approval

An explicit yes — spoken or written — to the plan as a whole, or yes to each section. "Looks good, but change X" is not a yes: revise X and re-present. Silence is not a yes. "Do whatever you think" is not a yes either — it means the customer hasn't engaged, and you'll be executing without a commitment.

Record it: the date, what was approved, and what changed in the final version. One line in a notebook is enough. That line is the gate.

If the customer is you — the owner running your own marketing — write the plan down anyway and put today's date on it. The signature matters. It's the line between "I'm trying social media" and "I'm running a plan."

The gate, stated plainly

Until approval is recorded, Chapters 4 through 14 stay closed. Execution without approval is how you build the wrong thing efficiently. The interview told you the truth, the picture organized it, the approval committed to it. Now — and only now — the work begins.

The exact prompts

Draft my approval-ready plan:

Here's my full-picture summary: [PASTE IT]. Draft a 90-day social media plan I can present for approval, with: (1) recommended channels and one line each on why, tied to my ideal customer; (2) my five content pillars shaped for my specific business; (3) a posting cadence that fits my stated daily time; (4) a month-by-month sketch for 90 days; (5) what success looks like — metrics, a weekly review rhythm, and when to change course if something stays flat; (6) what I need from the customer (or from myself): access, photos, review speed, who approves what. End with a one-paragraph plain-language summary I can read aloud in the approval meeting. Nothing after the plan — no execution steps yet.

Quick-Start: your first week after approval

Your plan is approved. The interview is done, the full picture is written, and someone said yes to the plan. Now move — run this seven-day sprint. By next week you'll have a working rhythm, and the rest of the book becomes your reference shelf.

Day 1 — Pick your pillars (30 minutes). Skim Chapter 4. Write down your five content pillars on an index card. Tape it where you'll see it. Every post you make from now on belongs to one pillar.

Day 2 — Draft five posts with AI (45 minutes). Use the prompts at the end of Chapter 5. One idea, five posts. Don't aim for brilliant — aim for done and true.

Day 3 — Schedule them (30 minutes). Put the five posts on your Facebook Page at consistent times across the week. (Chapter 6 has the daypart map.) One less thing to think about each morning.

Days 3–7 — Engage twenty minutes a day. Morning coffee, phone in hand: reply to every comment and message from the last day. That's it. Chapter 11 is the full routine; for this week, just reply to everybody like they're standing in your shop.

Day 7 — Read your numbers (30 minutes). Open each platform, write down which post got the most real engagement (comments and shares, not just likes), and ask one question: *what do the winners have in common?* Chapter 12 turns that question into a weekly habit.

That's the whole sprint. When you see the first stranger comment on your post because the process put you in front of them, you'll believe the rest of this book.

The exact prompts

Your pillar starter:

I run a [TYPE OF BUSINESS] in [CITY/REGION]. My customers are [DESCRIBE THEM]. Suggest 5 content pillars for my social media — recurring themes I can post about every week without running out of ideas. For each pillar, give me 3 specific post ideas I could make this month. Plain language, no marketing jargon.

Your first five posts:

Using these content pillars [PASTE YOUR 5 PILLARS], draft 5 Facebook posts for my [TYPE OF BUSINESS]. Each post should be under 120 words, end with a question my customers would actually want to answer, and sound like a real person wrote it — plainspoken and warm, never salesy. No emojis in the first line. Give me the pillar name above each post so I can see the mix.

Chapter 4: Pick your content pillars

Here's the mistake almost every small business makes on social media: they post whatever occurs to them that day. A sale flyer on Monday. A blurry shop photo on Thursday. Nothing for three weeks. Then a desperate "SUPPORT LOCAL!" post.

Random posting trains your audience to ignore you. Pillars fix that. A pillar is a recurring theme — a bucket you can pull from every single week without ever staring at a blank screen wondering what to post.

The five pillars

1. **TEACH.** Show what you know. The fix, the tip, the thing customers always get wrong. A plumber teaches why drains gurgle. A salon teaches why box dye fights the stylist. Teaching builds authority, and authority is what makes someone call you instead of the other guy.
2. **PROVE.** Show the work. Before-and-afters, the job in progress, the problem you solved today. Proof beats promises every time. A photo of the actual work with one honest line outperforms any stock photo with a slogan.
3. **INVITE.** Ask the audience in. Questions, polls, "which one would you pick," debates. Invitations are the engine of comments, and comments are the engine of reach. (Chapter 10 is the full hook and copy framework — this pillar is where it lives.)
4. **ENTERTAIN.** Be a human. The shop dog, the Friday laugh, the story about the job that went sideways. People follow people, not businesses. Entertainment posts rarely sell anything directly — they keep you in the feed so the selling posts get seen.
5. **SELL.** The offer. The product, the booking link, the seasonal special. This pillar works *because* the other four exist. If every post is a sell post, people tune out. If one in five is, they pay attention.

The mix

Aim for roughly this balance across a week of posts: two Teach, two Prove, two Invite, one Entertain, one Sell. It doesn't have to be exact — but if you look back at your last ten posts and seven of them are Sell, you've found your problem.

Brand-correctness: stay in your world

Every word and every image belongs to *your* world. The plumber doesn't post about carburetors. The bakery doesn't post gym memes. It sounds obvious, but the fastest way to confuse an audience is to borrow somebody else's content because it was funny. Your pillars are your fence. If a post idea doesn't fit a pillar, it doesn't go out.

And one more rule that matters more than it sounds: **if your copy names a specific thing, the image must be that exact thing**. If the post is about the 1968 Mustang you restored, the photo is that car — not a stock photo of a different Mustang. Customers notice. Trust is the whole game.

The exact prompts

Pillar audit (run this on your last month):

Here are my last 10 social media posts: [PASTE THEM, or describe each in one line]. Sort each one into these pillars: TEACH, PROVE, INVITE, ENTERTAIN, SELL. Then tell me: which pillars am I overusing, which am I neglecting, and what's the one change that would balance my mix? Be blunt.

Pillar idea refill (when a bucket runs dry):

My TEACH pillar for my [TYPE OF BUSINESS] is running dry. My customers are [DESCRIBE THEM]. Give me 10 specific teaching post ideas — real questions my customers actually ask, misconceptions they have, or small jobs they could understand better. One line each. No generic advice.

Chapter 5: The repurposing engine — one idea, five posts

Here's the math that makes this whole playbook possible: you do not need five ideas a day. You need **one good idea a week**, run through the repurposing engine.

Most small businesses quit social media because they think they need endless new ideas. They don't. They need one idea, expressed five ways, on five surfaces. The engine is a pipeline with five stages:

The pipeline: **IDEA > DRAFT > ADAPT > SCHEDULE > VERIFY**

IDEA. One thing worth saying. A job you did, a question a customer asked, a tip from your pillar list. Write it in one sentence. That's the seed. (Stuck? The Chapter 4 refill prompt grows seeds on demand.)

DRAFT. Turn the seed into one solid piece of copy with AI — a single Facebook-style post, 80 to 150 words, with a closer that invites a reply. Read it out loud. Fix anything that doesn't sound like you. This draft is the master copy everything else comes from.

ADAPT. Rewrite the master copy once per platform. Not copy-paste — *adapted*:

- **Facebook:** the full post, conversational, question closer.
- **Instagram:** shorter, punchier, visual-first — the image or reel carries it, the caption supports.
- **YouTube:** the idea becomes a video outline or a community post; the title says exactly what the viewer gets.
- **Pinterest:** the idea becomes a pin title and description that someone could *search for* six months from now.
- **Email (bonus):** the same idea, stretched slightly, becomes a newsletter paragraph.

One idea, five surfaces, five wordings. Never post identical wording everywhere — each platform's audience reads differently, and duplicate text looks lazy when someone follows you in two places.

SCHEDULE. Put adapted posts on the calendar at consistent times. Consistency beats cleverness: your audience can't develop a habit around you if you post at random. (Chapter 6 has the daypart map.) Schedule a few days out so a busy

Tuesday doesn't mean a silent page.

VERIFY. After posting time passes, check that the post actually went live — on the platform itself, not just in whatever tool you used to schedule it. A scheduler saying "done" is not the same as a post your customers can see. This thirty-second check catches the silent failures that make people think "social media doesn't work."

The dedup habit

Keep a simple running list of what you've posted — even a notebook works. Before the ADAPT step, glance at it. If you said the same thing last month, either skip it or say it from a genuinely new angle. Audiences forgive repetition of *themes* (that's what pillars are for); they punish repetition of *wording*.

Tag your links

Whenever a post links to your website, add a simple tag to the link so you can tell which post sent the visitor. (If you've heard the term "UTM parameters," that's all this is — a few extra words on the end of your web address that say "this visitor came from Tuesday's Facebook post.") Chapter 12 shows you how to read them. Untagged links are invisible effort — you did the work and can't prove it worked.

The exact prompts

The idea multiplier (IDEA > five drafts):

Here's one idea for my [TYPE OF BUSINESS]: [ONE SENTENCE]. Turn it into 5 adapted posts: (1) a Facebook post under 150 words ending with a question, (2) an Instagram caption under 60 words with 5 relevant hashtags, (3) a YouTube video title plus a 3-point outline for a 3-minute video, (4) a Pinterest pin title plus a 2-sentence searchable description, (5) one email newsletter paragraph. Plainspoken and warm. Each version worded differently — no copy-paste between them.

The adapter (when you already have a good post):

Here's a post that performed well for my [TYPE OF BUSINESS]: [PASTE IT]. Adapt it for [INSTAGRAM / YOUTUBE / PINTEREST / EMAIL] keeping the core idea but rewriting it for how people read on that platform. Don't reuse the same sentences.

The verifier's checklist (run weekly):

Act as my posting assistant. Here's what I scheduled this week: [LIST]. For each item, the check is: did it actually publish on the platform, does the link work, and is the wording different from anything I posted in the last 30 days? Give me a simple pass/fail table and flag anything that needs a repost.

Chapter 6: Facebook — your home base

For most local and trade businesses, Facebook is still where the customers are. It's your home base: the Page is your storefront, and Facebook Groups are the rooms where your customers already hang out.

The Page, not just a profile

Run your business presence as a **Facebook Page**, not your personal profile. Pages can be found by strangers, can run all the business features, and — this matters — keep your business and personal life separate. Post as the Page, every time. Before you hit publish or reply, glance at *who you're acting as*. Posting business content from the wrong identity is the kind of small mistake that confuses people.

Cadence: the daypart map

Post **three to five times a day** on your Page, at consistent times. Here's an example daypart map — adjust the hours to when *your* customers are on their phones:

- **Early morning** (around 6:15 AM) — the coffee scroll. Light, inviting content.
- **Late morning** (around 11:30 AM) — the lunch-break scroll. Teaching posts do well here.
- **Early afternoon** (around 1:30 PM) — proof posts, job photos.
- **Evening** (around 8:00 PM) — the couch scroll. Stories, entertainment, the sell post.

Weekends get one extra early-afternoon slot — people scroll more on weekends. The exact times matter less than the consistency. Pick your slots, keep them for a month, and let the numbers in Chapter 12 tell you which slots earn their keep.

Start slower if you need to — two posts a day at consistent times beats five posts whenever you remember. Build up to the full cadence as the habit solidifies.

The follow routine: earn your audience

Followers don't appear because you exist. Every day, spend a few minutes finding the rooms and people in your world:

1. **Follow or join 10 relevant targets a day** — pages, groups, and people in your niche and your service area. Real ones, relevant to buyers. Not vanity accounts, not follow-for-follow schemes.
2. **Pace it.** A few in the morning, a few midday, a few in the evening — with normal browsing in between. Never blast through a hundred follows in one sitting.
3. **The platform is always watching velocity.** If Facebook ever shows you a warning, a captcha, or a temporary block: **stop for the day.** Do not push through. One paused day costs you nothing; a restricted account costs you weeks.
4. **Backlog-first.** Keep a running list of targets. Work the oldest first, add new ones at the end, and cross off what you've done. A notebook or a simple document works fine.

Ten a day is 300 a month. That's how audiences get built — steadily, not virally.

Groups: be a member first

Facebook Groups are where the real conversations happen — trade groups, hobby groups, neighborhood groups, owner groups. The rule for groups is simple and absolute:

Contribute first. Mention your business rarely, and only when it's genuinely useful.

The formula for a group comment:

1. **Be social first.** A genuine reaction to *that* post — real knowledge, a specific detail, a shared experience, a little humor where it fits. Show you belong in the room.
2. **The offer second — or not at all.** One short line, only if it fits naturally. If the offer would look forced on that post, skip it. A great comment with no offer beats a forced pitch every time.
3. **Never paste a template blind.** Read the post. Read the top comments. Then write. People can tell.

Roughly one touch in ten may carry a soft, genuinely relevant mention of what you sell. Never a hard sell, never off-topic. In rooms marked as social-only (someone else's community with strict rules), it's zero promotion — you're a member, not a marketer. If a host or moderator pushes back, withdraw quietly. No arguments. Your reputation in a group is worth more than any single post.

And: **no links in the social part of a comment.** If you do drop an offer line where the group's rules allow it, that's the one place a single link may live.

The exact prompts

Your daypart planner:

I run a [TYPE OF BUSINESS] and my customers are mostly [DESCRIBE THEM — e.g., homeowners 30-55, on their phones early morning and evening]. Design a daily posting schedule for my Facebook Page: 4 posts on weekdays, 5 on weekends, with specific times and which content pillar (TEACH, PROVE, INVITE, ENTERTAIN, SELL) fits each slot best. Explain each choice in one line.

Your follow-list builder:

I run a [TYPE OF BUSINESS] in [CITY/REGION]. List 30 Facebook pages and groups I should follow or join: half in my trade/niche, half local community groups where my customers hang out. For each, one line on why it's relevant. Real, findable names — no made-up groups.

The group comment drafter:

I'm commenting as my business page in a Facebook group for [AUDIENCE]. Here's the post I'm replying to: [PASTE OR DESCRIBE IT]. Draft a comment that: opens with a genuine, knowledgeable reaction to THIS specific post (no generic praise), adds one useful detail from a [TRADE] professional's perspective, and — only if it fits naturally — ends with one soft line about [YOUR OFFER]. If the offer doesn't fit, leave it out. Keep it under 80 words. Sound like a real person, not a brand.

Chapter 7: Instagram

Instagram is the visual wing of your operation. Same pillars, same voice — but the image or the reel carries the weight, and the caption supports it. Think of Facebook as the conversation and Instagram as the portfolio.

Reels first

Short video gets the reach. You don't need production value — you need a phone, decent light, and something real to point it at. The formats in Chapter 10 were built for exactly this: the 30-second shop moment, the before-and-after, the quick tip to camera.

Practical rules:

- **One idea per reel.** Not three tips — one.
- **Say the interesting thing in the first three seconds.** "Here's why your drain gurgles" beats five seconds of "hey guys welcome back to my channel."
- **Captions are short.** Under 60 words, then a few genuinely relevant hashtags (five is plenty — not thirty). Hashtags are labels, not lottery tickets.
- **Post reels at the same cadence as your Page** — the repurposing engine in Chapter 5 already made the caption. Don't let Instagram become the platform you "get to later."

Stories: the behind-the-scenes

Stories are where the unpolished stuff lives — the job site at 7 AM, the "guess what walked in today" photo, the quick poll. They disappear in a day, which makes them the lowest-pressure content you make. Use them daily if you can; they keep you at the top of people's minds between the bigger posts.

Comments and tags: reply to everything

Instagram runs on reciprocity. Reply to every genuine comment — especially in the first few days after posting, when the platform is deciding how far to push your reel. A reply counts as engagement too, and it turns a viewer into a conversation.

The exact prompts

The reel script builder:

Write a 30-second reel script for my [TYPE OF BUSINESS]. The topic: [ONE TOPIC]. Structure: hook in the first 3 seconds (say the interesting thing immediately), one clear point in the middle, and a one-line closer that asks viewers a question. Write it as spoken lines I can read to the camera, plainspoken, no jargon. Include a caption under 50 words and 5 relevant hashtags.

The caption shortener:

Here's my Facebook post: [PASTE IT]. Rewrite it as an Instagram caption under 60 words — keep the core idea and the question closer, cut everything else. Add 5 genuinely relevant hashtags for a [TYPE OF BUSINESS] in [CITY/REGION]. No generic tags like #love or #instagood.

Chapter 8: YouTube

YouTube is the slow-burn platform — and the highest-trust one. A customer who watched your five-minute video explaining a repair trusts you more than one who liked ten of your photos. Video builds the kind of authority that books jobs.

Pace your uploads

Upload on a steady rhythm — once or twice a week beats ten videos in a weekend followed by two silent months. And when you're catching up on a backlog, **upload gradually**. Dumping dozens of videos at once looks like spam to the platform and to subscribers. Steady wins.

Titles that say what the viewer gets

The title is a promise. "How to Tell If Your Water Heater Is Dying (3 Signs)" beats "Water Heater Video #4." Say what the viewer will learn, in the words they'd type into the search bar. Never reuse the exact same title twice — if two videos need similar titles, differentiate them ("...for Gas Models" vs. "...for Electric Models").

Descriptions that work while you sleep

The description box is searchable, clickable real estate:

- First two lines: what the video covers and who it's for.
- Then: your website link, the relevant service or product page, and how to contact you.
- Keep it honest — the description should describe *this* video, not be a generic ad pasted everywhere.

The pinned comment

After uploading, pin a comment with the single next step: the booking link, the related video, the free guide. Most viewers never open the description; many read the comments. The pinned comment is your second chance at the call to action.

Watch it before you call it done

Before you consider any video finished — yours or anyone's you hired — **watch the whole thing at normal speed, start to finish.** Spot-checking the first thirty seconds doesn't catch the glitch at minute four, the wrong caption, or the ending that falls apart. Your eyes on the full playback are the final quality gate. No exceptions.

The exact prompts

Title and description generator:

I made a YouTube video for my [TYPE OF BUSINESS] about [TOPIC]. The video covers these 3 points: [POINT 1], [POINT 2], [POINT 3]. Give me: 5 title options (each under 60 characters, saying clearly what the viewer learns, in words a customer would search for), a 150-word description (first two lines: what the video covers and who it's for; then my website [URL], my contact [PHONE/EMAIL]), and one pinned comment with a single clear next step. Plainspoken, no clickbait.

The video outline builder:

Outline a 5-minute YouTube video for my [TYPE OF BUSINESS] on [TOPIC]. Structure: a 15-second hook that states what the viewer will learn, 3 main sections with a concrete example or visual for each, and a 20-second closer with one call to action. Write it as bullet talking points, not a word-for-word script — I want to sound like me, not like I'm reading.

Chapter 9: Pinterest

Pinterest isn't really social media — it's a search engine with pictures. People go there *looking* for ideas: the kitchen remodel, the wedding hairstyle, the garden layout, the pattern. A pin you post today can send visitors to your site six months from now. Nothing else in this book has that shelf life.

One pin per thing worth finding

Every product, every service, every useful post on your website deserves a pin. The formula:

- **Image:** clear, vertical, showing the thing. Text overlay with the promise ("5 Questions to Ask Before You Hire a Roofer") is fine — keep it readable on a phone.
- **Title:** what someone would search for. Think like your customer typing, not like a marketer writing.
- **Description:** two or three sentences with natural keywords, ending with what they'll find when they click.
- **Link:** always back to the right page on *your* site. A pin without a working link is a dead end.

Boards organized by customer problem

Don't organize boards around your business ("Our Services"). Organize around the customer's problem ("Fixing a Leaky Faucet," "Small Bathroom Ideas," "What to Ask a Contractor"). People browse problems, not vendor taxonomies.

The exact prompts

The pin set builder:

I run a [TYPE OF BUSINESS]. Here's a page on my website: [URL + one-line description of what's on it]. Create 3 Pinterest pins for it: each with a searchable title (under 60 characters, in the words a customer would type), a 2-3 sentence description with natural keywords, and a short text-overlay line for the pin image. Make each of the 3 pins angle at a different customer problem.

The board planner:

I run a [TYPE OF BUSINESS] serving [CUSTOMERS]. Suggest 8 Pinterest board titles organized around my customers' problems and questions — not around my services. For each board, one line describing what gets pinned there.

Chapter 10: Hooks and copy frameworks

This is the chapter that makes everything else work harder. A hook is the first line — the thing that decides whether someone keeps reading or keeps scrolling. You have about two seconds. Here are nine frameworks that earn those two seconds. Borrow the *structure*, never anyone else's footage or wording — and verify every fact before you post it, especially numbers and specs. One wrong spec in front of people who know the subject destroys trust faster than anything else.

1. The debate-bait quiz

Challenge the viewer's knowledge, then give them an effortless way to answer. "How much of a [trade] pro are you? Name this fitting." "Guess the year from these three clues." Nobody scrolls past an identity challenge — and comments become answers and arguments, which is exactly what the platform rewards.

2. Versus / pick-one

Two contenders, one forced choice. "1969 or 1967 — which one are you taking?" "Tankless or tank — settle it." Forced choice splits the audience into camps, and camps argue. Give each side one good piece of ammo so the debate has substance.

3. The vote-closer walkthrough

Walk through something real — the job site, the project, the problem — with honest narration, then end on a binary question. "Keep it original or full restoration?" "Repair or replace?" The vote is effortless to answer, and the walkthrough taught them something along the way.

4. Hero spotlight + question closer

Showcase one thing at its best — the finished job, the beautiful result — with short, declarative narration and one direct-address question: "Would you take the keys?" Direct address turns a passive viewer into someone answering.

5. Precision narration

For audiences who respect expertise: exact numbers, exact specs, narrated as knowledge. This is save-worthy content — people bookmark it and come back. The rule is absolute: **verify every number**. Precision is the content; wrong precision is the end of your credibility.

6. The obscure deep-dive

The thing most people in your world have never heard of. "The engine you never heard of." "The code requirement nobody follows." Obscurity is the hook — and because it gets fact-checked the hardest, verify everything twice.

7. The beauty walkaround

One subject, multiple angles, minimal words. Cheap to produce in volume; the subject carries the piece. The finished kitchen. The restored car. The garden in bloom. Let it breathe.

8. The owner story

First-person, real, specific. The day you opened. The job that taught you everything. The thing your dad told you. Heritage and emotion invite other people's stories in the replies — and nothing builds a community like shared stories. Keep it genuine. Never fabricate a memory.

9. The shop moment

Raw, real, one honest line. The first start. The reveal. The end-of-day "what do you think?" Authenticity of real work, lowest-friction comment bait there is. These are the cheapest posts you'll ever make and often the best-performing.

Anatomy of every post: hook > middle > closer

Whatever framework you pick, the skeleton is the same:

- **Hook** (line one): the interesting thing, immediately. A question, a challenge, a bold true claim.
- **Middle** (the body): deliver on the hook. Teach, show, or tell — no filler.
- **Closer** (last line): one question your audience actually wants to answer. Not "let me know what you think" — something specific. "Would you repair it or replace it?" "What's the oldest one of these you've seen in the wild?"

The exact prompts

The hook rewriter:

Here's a dull post I wrote for my [TYPE OF BUSINESS]: [PASTE IT]. Rewrite just the first line 5 different ways using these frameworks: (1) a debate-bait quiz question, (2) a versus/pick-one forced choice, (3) a bold true claim, (4) a direct-address question, (5) an obscure-fact teaser. Keep each hook under 15 words. Then pick the strongest one and tell me why in one sentence.

The format picker:

I want to post about [TOPIC] for my [TYPE OF BUSINESS] on [FACEBOOK / INSTAGRAM REEL / YOUTUBE]. Which of these frameworks fits best — debate quiz, versus, vote-closer walkthrough, hero spotlight, precision narration, deep-dive, beauty walkaround, owner story, or shop moment — and why? Then draft the post in that framework: hook, middle, question closer. Under 150 words.

The closer sharpener:

Here are 3 posts I wrote: [PASTE THEM]. Each one currently ends weakly. Write a stronger closing question for each — specific, easy to answer, something my [DESCRIBE CUSTOMERS] would have an opinion about. No "let me know your thoughts."

Chapter 11: The engagement routine

Posting is half the job. The other half is showing up in the conversations your posts start — and in the conversations already happening in your world. This is the daily routine that turns followers into customers.

The daily twenty minutes

Once a day — morning coffee works — open every platform and handle what's new:

1. **Reply to every genuine comment.** Questions, compliments, stories, even the short ones. A reply is engagement the platform counts, and it's basic manners.
2. **Reply to messages.** Warm inbound messages get a real answer, promptly. (Cold outreach to strangers is a different thing entirely — don't do it. Answer the people who came to you.)
3. **Check mentions and tags.** Someone tagged your business? Show up and say thanks.
4. **Sweep your groups.** The rooms from Chapter 6 — drop into the active threads, be useful, be social.

The 72-hour rule

Don't just handle today's items. Look back **three days**. A thoughtful reply to a two-day-old comment is still live engagement — the person gets notified, the thread wakes back up, and everyone watching sees a business that actually responds. Most businesses ignore anything older than a day. That's your opening.

Junk removal vs. genuine criticism — know the difference

On pages and accounts you own, keep the place clean:

Remove quietly: spam links, crypto and bot comments, scams, hate speech, gibberish, and unsolicited ads from others using your page as their billboard ("DM me for promo," link-drops for someone else's product). No public callouts, no arguments about it — remove it and move on. Your page is not ad space for someone else.

NEVER remove: genuine questions, genuine criticism, genuine complaints. Those get *answered* — publicly, graciously, fast. A complaint handled well in public is worth ten five-star reviews. Deleting criticism is the fastest way to turn one unhappy customer into a story everyone shares.

The test is simple: are they participating, or are they using you as a billboard? Participant stays. Billboard goes.

Clean-when-done

When you've handled a notification — replied, answered, removed — clear it. Archive it, mark it read, whatever the platform offers. Every surface stays clean, so tomorrow's twenty minutes starts from zero instead of from a pile. This applies everywhere: inboxes, notifications, comment threads.

The identity check

If more than one person posts for your business — or you run multiple pages — verify *who you're acting as* before every reply and every post. Every time, not once per session. Replying to a plumbing customer as your bakery page is funny exactly once, and then it's a problem.

The exact prompts

The reply drafter:

I'm replying to comments on my [TYPE OF BUSINESS] page. Here's the comment: "[PASTE IT]". Draft a reply that: answers the actual question or acknowledges the actual point (no generic "thanks!"), sounds like a real person — plainspoken and warm, and ends with a natural follow-up question or next step where it fits. Under 40 words. If the comment is a complaint, be gracious and specific, never defensive.

The criticism response helper:

A customer left this critical comment on my page: "[PASTE IT]". Help me write a public reply that: thanks them for telling me, takes the specific concern seriously (no corporate non-apology), says what I'll do about it in one concrete sentence, and invites them to continue privately at [PHONE/EMAIL]. Under 80 words. Warm, human, no jargon. Then give me 3 questions to ask myself about whether this complaint points to a real process problem.

Chapter 12: Read the numbers, then iterate

Everything so far is the machine. This chapter is the steering wheel. Once a week — thirty minutes, same day, same chair — you review what happened and change what isn't working.

The weekly review: four questions

1. **What went out?** List every post you published this week, per platform. If you can't list them, your scheduling is the first thing to fix.
2. **What got real engagement?** For each post, note the comments and shares — not just likes. (Likes are cheap; comments and shares mean someone cared.) Rank the week's posts best to worst.
3. **What sent people to your website?** This is where those tagged links from Chapter 5 pay off. Which posts actually sent visitors? A post with 200 likes and zero clicks is entertainment. A post with 20 likes and 15 clicks is marketing. Know which is which.
4. **What do the winners have in common?** Same pillar? Same format? Same time slot? Same topic? The pattern is the whole prize — it tells you what to make more of.

Winners, losers, gaps

Sort your findings into three buckets and act on each:

- **WINNERS — do more.** Your top two or three posts. The action is concrete: "make three more vote-closer posts," "move the Tuesday teaching post to the evening slot." Winners get repeated *this week*, not someday.
- **LOSERS — kill or fix.** The formats that consistently land flat. Give a format two or three honest tries, then kill it without sentimentality. "We've always posted quote cards" is not a strategy.
- **GAPS — fix the plumbing.** Links you forgot to tag. Posts that went out at the wrong time. A platform you neglected all week. Gaps are usually process failures, not content failures — fix the process.

One more bucket, used sparingly: **AMPLIFY**. Your single best organic post of the week — the one you'd put money behind. *Flag it, don't fund it* until you've thought it through: boosting costs real money, and the right post to boost is the one that's already winning, not the one you wish were winning.

The effectiveness rule

This is the most important paragraph in the book:

If something shows no positive movement after a few days of honest effort, the approach is broken — change it. Don't ride a flat tactic for a month hoping it turns. New angle, new format, new time slot, or kill it and reallocate the effort. A worker producing nothing for days is a failure, not patience. That applies to your posts, your platforms, and any help you've hired.

Trust, but verify

When you check whether scheduled posts went live, look at the *live platform*, not just your scheduling tool's dashboard. Dashboards say "done" when they mean "sent." Your customers see the platform. The platform is the truth.

And a final honesty rule for your numbers: **never fabricate a metric.** If you can't measure something, write "unknown" — an honest gap beats a comforting fiction. Decisions made on invented numbers are worse than decisions made on no numbers.

The exact prompts

The weekly review summarizer:

Here's what I posted this week for my [TYPE OF BUSINESS]: [LIST EACH POST: platform, day/time, topic, and the engagement it got — comments, shares, likes]. Analyze it: rank the posts, tell me what the top 3 have in common (pillar, format, topic, timing), name the 2 weakest and whether I should fix or kill each, and give me 3 concrete changes for next week's content. Be blunt — no participation trophies.

The kill-or-keep judge:

I've posted [FORMAT TYPE] [NUMBER] times over the last [TIMEFRAME] for my [TYPE OF BUSINESS]. Here's how each one performed: [RESULTS]. Should I kill it, fix it, or keep it? If fix: what's the one change most likely to save it? If kill: what should replace it in my rotation? One paragraph, direct.

Chapter 13: Build the community

Posts get attention. Community gets customers — the kind who come back, who send their neighbors, who defend you in the comments. Community is built deliberately, in five layers.

Layer 1: Your founder story

Write it down, once, properly. Who you are, why you do this work, what you believe about doing it right. Real details, real history — **zero placeholders, zero invented color**. If you don't have a dramatic origin story, good: "I've been fixing furnaces in this county for twenty years and I still like it" is a better story than a fabricated legend. Publish it on your website and pin it where new followers land. People buy from people they feel they know.

Layer 2: Reviews and testimonials

Ask. That's the whole secret — almost nobody asks. After a good job, ask for a review, and make it easy (send the link). When someone says something nice unprompted, ask permission to quote them, then *publish it* — on your site, in your posts, in your emails. A permissioned testimonial is an asset; an unpermissioned one is a risk. Always ask.

Layer 3: The email list

Social platforms are rented land — the algorithm can change the rent tomorrow. Your email list is owned land. Offer something genuinely useful in exchange for an address: a seasonal checklist, a buyer's guide, a "what to ask before you hire" sheet. Then email the list when you have something worth saying — not daily noise. The list is the asset that survives every algorithm change.

Layer 4: Cross-promotion

Find two or three non-competing businesses that serve your same customers and promote each other. The roofer and the gutter company. The salon and the boutique. The plumber and the remodeler. One genuine recommendation post a month, both directions. It costs nothing and borrows trust that takes years to build alone.

Layer 5: The seasonal calendar

Once a year, map your twelve months: what does your customer need *this* month? The HVAC company owns October (furnace tune-ups) and April (AC season). The landscaper owns March (spring cleanups) and September (fall work). Seasonal posts write themselves when the calendar tells you what's urgent — and urgency is what makes people act now instead of someday.

The exact prompts

The founder story interview:

Interview me for my business founder story. Ask me one question at a time about: how I started, the hardest job or year, what I believe about doing good work, and what I want customers to know about me. After I've answered, draft a 300-word founder story in first person — plainspoken, warm, specific. Use only what I told you. No invented details, no placeholder brackets.

The testimonial request:

A customer just told me [WHAT THEY SAID] about a job we did: [ONE-LINE DESCRIPTION]. Draft a short message asking their permission to quote them (first name and last initial only) on my website and social media. Warm, grateful, no pressure — make it easy to say yes and easy to say no.

The seasonal calendar builder:

I run a [TYPE OF BUSINESS] serving [CUSTOMERS] in [REGION]. Build me a 12-month seasonal content calendar: for each month, the one thing my customers most need to hear about, the urgency behind it, and one post idea (with hook) for it. One line per month, then expand the 3 highest-urgency months into full post drafts.

Chapter 14: Guardrails

Everything in this book works — right up until it doesn't, because a guardrail got ignored. These are non-negotiable.

No politics. Ever. Not hints, not memes, not "just asking questions." Your business pages exist to serve customers. Politics costs you half your audience to entertain the other half, and neither half came to your page for that.

Verify before you post. If your copy states a fact — a spec, a price, a date, a claim about a product — check it first. Never wing a number. In front of people who know the subject, one wrong fact ends the trust you've spent months building.

Customer experience first. Every decision — what to post, how often, how to reply, what to sell — gets judged by one question: *is this good for the customer?* Growth tactics that annoy your audience aren't growth. They're a slow leak.

Pace yourself on every platform. New account or new tactic? Start slow, watch for warnings, scale gradually. If any platform shows a warning, a captcha, a throttle, or a block — **stop for the day.** Pushing through restrictions is how accounts get limited. The algorithm rewards steady; it punishes frantic.

AI drafts, you decide. Worth repeating from page one: nothing goes out under your name that you haven't read. AI is the engine, not the driver.

Never delete the truth. You can remove spam and scams from your pages. You can never remove a genuine complaint or a fair criticism — you answer it. (Chapter 11.)

Keep business and personal separate. Business content goes out as the business. Your personal profile is not your marketing channel.

The exact prompts

The pre-publish checklist:

Here's a post I'm about to publish for my [TYPE OF BUSINESS]: [PASTE IT]. Run the guardrail check: (1) flag any factual claim I should verify before posting, (2) flag anything that could read as political, (3) flag anything that sounds fake, templated, or off-brand for a plainspoken local business, (4) confirm the closer is a real question. Give me a pass/fail on each with one-line fixes.

Your 90-day calendar: putting it all together

You've got the pieces. Here's how they assemble across your first quarter.

Month 1 — Foundations

- **Week 1:** Run the Quick-Start sprint (the section right after Chapter 3) — your first approved week. Pillars picked, five posts drafted, first engagement habit built.
- **Week 2:** Set up the repurposing engine (Chapter 5). One idea a week, five surfaces. Start the follow routine — ten relevant targets a day, paced.
- **Week 3:** Join your three best groups. Start commenting with the Chapter 6 formula — social first, offer rarely. Write your founder story (Chapter 13).
- **Week 4:** Run your first weekly numbers review (Chapter 12). Kill your worst format. Start your email list with one genuinely useful freebie.

Month 2 — Rhythm

- The cadence is automatic now: draft day, schedule day, twenty minutes of engagement daily.
- Add YouTube (one video a week) or Pinterest (five pins a week) — whichever fits your business better. Not both at once.
- First cross-promotion post with a neighboring business.
- Review the month: which pillar pulls the most engagement? Double down on it next month.

Month 3 — Scale what wins

- Your winners are now obvious from eight weekly reviews. Make more of them — that's the whole strategy.
- Dead formats are gone, killed without sentimentality.
- The email list gets its first real send.
- Seasonal calendar is filled for the next two quarters.
- Ask yourself the effectiveness question honestly: what's flat? Change it this week.

The one-page version (tape this to the wall)

1. **Pillars:** Teach, Prove, Invite, Entertain, Sell.

2. Engine: one idea > draft > adapt per platform > schedule > verify it went live.

3. Cadence: 3–5 posts a day on Facebook at consistent times; steady everywhere else.

4. Engage: twenty minutes daily; reply to everything; 72-hour lookback; never delete real criticism.

5. Review: thirty minutes weekly; winners get repeated, losers get killed, gaps get fixed.

6. Guardrails: no politics, verify facts, customer first, stop on any platform warning.

That's the playbook. The rest is showing up.

SkillForge AI — practical AI playbooks for Main Street. Written by Muse for Bill Morton.